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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026
Fourth SEMESTER
Skill Enhancement Course (SEC) - MG4SECTTM200 - DIGITAL AND SOCIAL MEDIA COMMUNICATION IN TOURISM
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1 hour 30 minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Short Answer Questions, Answer any 5 questions, Each question carries 2 marks

1. **What is meant by implementing a travel trade website? [U]/ [CO1]**
   It means developing and launching an online platform to promote and sell travel products and services.

2. **What is customer database in E-tourism? [K]/ [CO3]**
   It is a digital collection of customer details used for managing bookings and personalized services.

3. **What is content management? [U]/ [CO4]**
   It is the process of creating, organizing, and updating digital content on a website.

4. **Mention two benefits of E-business partnerships for DMOs. [U]/ [CO2]**
   Wider market reach, Cost sharing / reduced marketing cost, Better service integration, Improved destination promotion, Access to technology and expertise, etc..

5. **What is meant by transaction security? [K]/ [CO3]**
   It refers to protecting online transactions and user data from fraud and unauthorized access.

6. **Define online travel intermediaries. [K]/ [CO2]**
   They are websites or platforms that connect travelers with travel service providers for bookings. OTAs like MakeMyTrip, Booking.com, Expedia

7. **Define e-commerce. [K]/ [CO4]**
   It is the buying and selling of goods and services through the internet.

8. **What is meant by changing business models of Global Distribution Systems? [U]/ [CO2]**
   It refers to the shift from traditional booking systems to modern, integrated online travel service platforms.

Part B

Short Essay Questions, Answer any 5 questions, Each question carries 5 marks

9. Discuss the features and global presence of Amadeus GDS. [U]/[CO2]

One of the leading global distribution systems, provides airline, hotel, rail, car rental, insurance, and other travel bookings, Real-time inventory and reservation, Used by travel agencies, airlines, OTAs, corporations, Global network and strong international presence, Advanced technology solutions and integration tools

10. Explain the concept and scope of E-Tourism in the modern travel industry [U]/[CO1]

E-tourism = application of ICT/internet in tourism, covers information search, booking, payment, promotion, CRM, service delivery, includes websites, mobile apps, social media, virtual tours, OTAs, GDS, Scope is broad and central to modern tourism operations

11. Explain online fraud prevention techniques.[K]/[CO3]

SSL encryption / secure payment gateway, Two-factor authentication, Strong passwords, Firewalls and antivirus, Fraud detection software, Customer verification, Regular monitoring and updates, Awareness and staff training

12. Describe the future trends in E-tourism. [K][/CO3]

AI and chatbots, Big data and personalization, Mobile-first booking, AR/VR virtual tours, Blockchain and secure payment, Voice search, Smart tourism / IoT, Sustainable digital tourism solutions

13. What are the key factors to evaluate website performance? [U]/[CO4]

Page loading speed, User-friendly design/navigation, Mobile responsiveness, Content quality and relevance, Security, Search engine visibility, Conversion rate / bookings / enquiries, Bounce rate / traffic analytics, etc.,

14. Explain the features of an e-commerce website. [U]/[CO4]

Product/service listing, Search and navigation, Booking/shopping cart, Secure payment gateway, User registration/login, Reviews and ratings, Order confirmation/tracking, Responsive design, Customer support/contact features, etc.

15. Explain B2B model with examples in tourism. [K]/[CO3]

B2B = business-to-business transactions, Tourism businesses deal with other tourism businesses, Examples: hotel contracting with tour operators, airline-GDS link, travel agent-wholesaler relationship, Benefits: efficiency, bulk business, long-term tie-ups, etc.

16. Discuss email marketing and its benefits. [U]/[CO4]

Use of email to promote tourism products/services, Sending offers, newsletters, updates, reminders, packages, Benefits: low cost, direct communication, personalization, measurable results, customer retention, etc.

Part C

Long Essay Questions, Answer any 1 questions, Each question carries 15 marks

17. Explain the evolution from Computer Reservation Systems (CRS) to Global Distribution Systems (GDS) and their role in tourism distribution. [U]/[CO2]

CRS originated for airline seat reservation, initially airline-specific/internal systems, expanded to include hotels, cars, rail, etc., Became GDS with multi-supplier, global access, Examples: Amadeus, Sabre, Galileo, Worldspan, Role in tourism distribution: central inventory, real-time booking, wider reach, travel agent access, efficiency, price comparison, Impact on modern tourism

18. Explain the delivery and management process in an online business with diagrams. [A]/[CO4]

Order placement, Payment processing, Confirmation, Inventory/service management, Delivery/service fulfilment, Customer support and feedback, Use of management systems (CMS, CRM, ERP, logistics), Diagram/flowchart representation

Simple Flow Diagram:

Customer Visit → Product/Service Selection → Order/Booking → Payment Gateway → Confirmation → Delivery/Fulfillment → Feedback/Support

Management Diagram:

Content Management + Inventory Management + Payment Security + CRM + Analytics → Efficient Online Business Operation

19. Analyse the role of technology in transforming traditional travel agencies into digital and online travel businesses. [K]/[CO3]

Traditional agencies were manual and office-based, Technology introduced websites, online booking, GDS, CRM, apps, email/social media marketing, digital payment, Shift to online customer engagement and automation, Benefits: wider reach, lower cost, faster service, personalization, 24/7 access, Challenges: competition, training needs, cybersecurity, adaptation